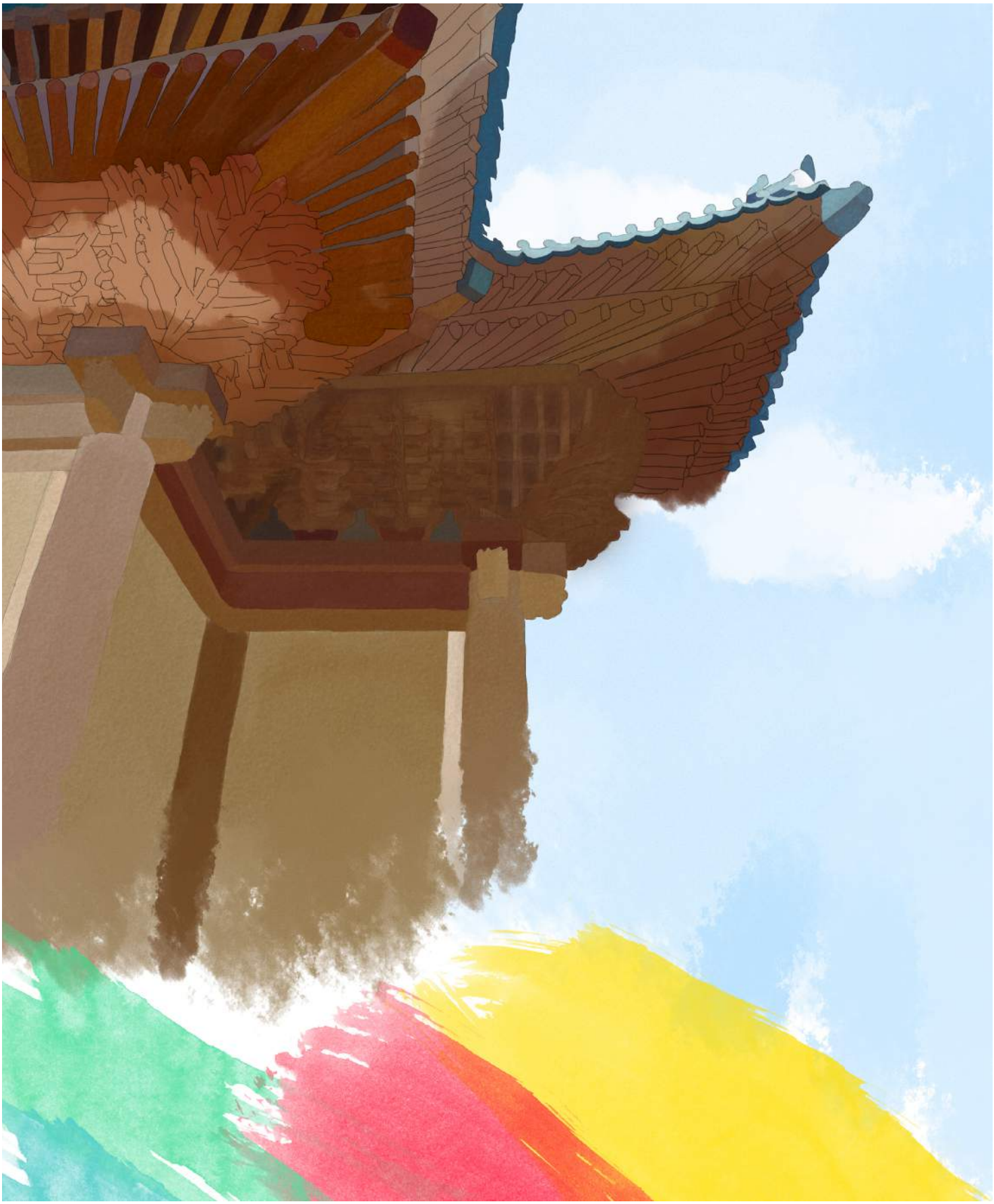
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Editor's Note

Dear Reader,

Life as a Korean high school student is not easy. Life in KMLA, if not more difficult, is also not an exception. What motivates us to endure are the little things: the smell of warm laundry on Fridays, a pretty sunset on the way to the dorm, and most of all, the people. Our everyday acquaintances become our every joy and sorrow. What makes KMLA special is the extraordinary sense of community that envelopes the student body, teachers, and staff members: the KMLA family.

But then, a question comes up and scratches at our conscience. How much do we actually know about our KMLA faculty? We spend the majority of our day in class with our teachers. In some cases, we actually live with them in the dorms. But it is questionable whether we recognize our beloved teachers outside the classroom — not as faculty — but plainly as human beings who can love, cry, and share a corny joke.

In this edition, Minjok Herald aims to spotlight the human aspects of our teachers, as true members of the KMLA family. Let us delve beyond the intimidating title of “academic instructor." What kind of people are our teachers? A person’s multi-faceted character cannot be defined by only their occupations. Perhaps this understanding will become one step forward in the student council’s mission for communication between student and school.

Starting my tenure as editor-in-chief, I have only one wish. Embrace what you read with an open heart. Smile at the funny episodes, and sympathize with stories of hardships. Be humbled at the criticisms, yet be angry when you have to. I hope you gain something meaningful while flipping through our pages. Share what you’ve read, debate on our issues, and provide constructive criticism. But above all else, learn to love the people around you today. Thank you.

Ahn Se-Bin
Editor-in-Chief
November 16th, 2015

Table of Contents

SNAPSHOTS 4

NEWS

7 For Whom the Elevator Exists

8 Yet Another Take on a Terminal Problem: Department Restructuring

9 Where Our Money Could Be Better Spent: What Students Actually Need

10 SAT and ACT... and New SAT?

11 KMLA's First TEDx, and Hopefully Not Its Last

12 FEATURE

TEACHERS OF KMLA
Kim Kyung-Ju
Kim Byeong-Mu
Lee Ju-Mun
Park Ju-Young

EDITORIAL

18 EOP: Why & How

COLUMN

20 The 20th Student Council Election: An Insider's View

22 We Need to Talk...

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4 SNAPSHOTS



tug-of-war at the annual sports festival



a rather feathery KMLAian



rock fusion band *Sosaoreum* at TEDxYouth@KMLA



painting the rest area-bound tunnel

seen at the eve party



the drone zone





^ 20th wave contenders for *ssireum*, or Korean wrestling, at the annual sports competition

v seen at the eve party



v Rhyme Factory performing at the eve party



For Whom the Elevator Exists

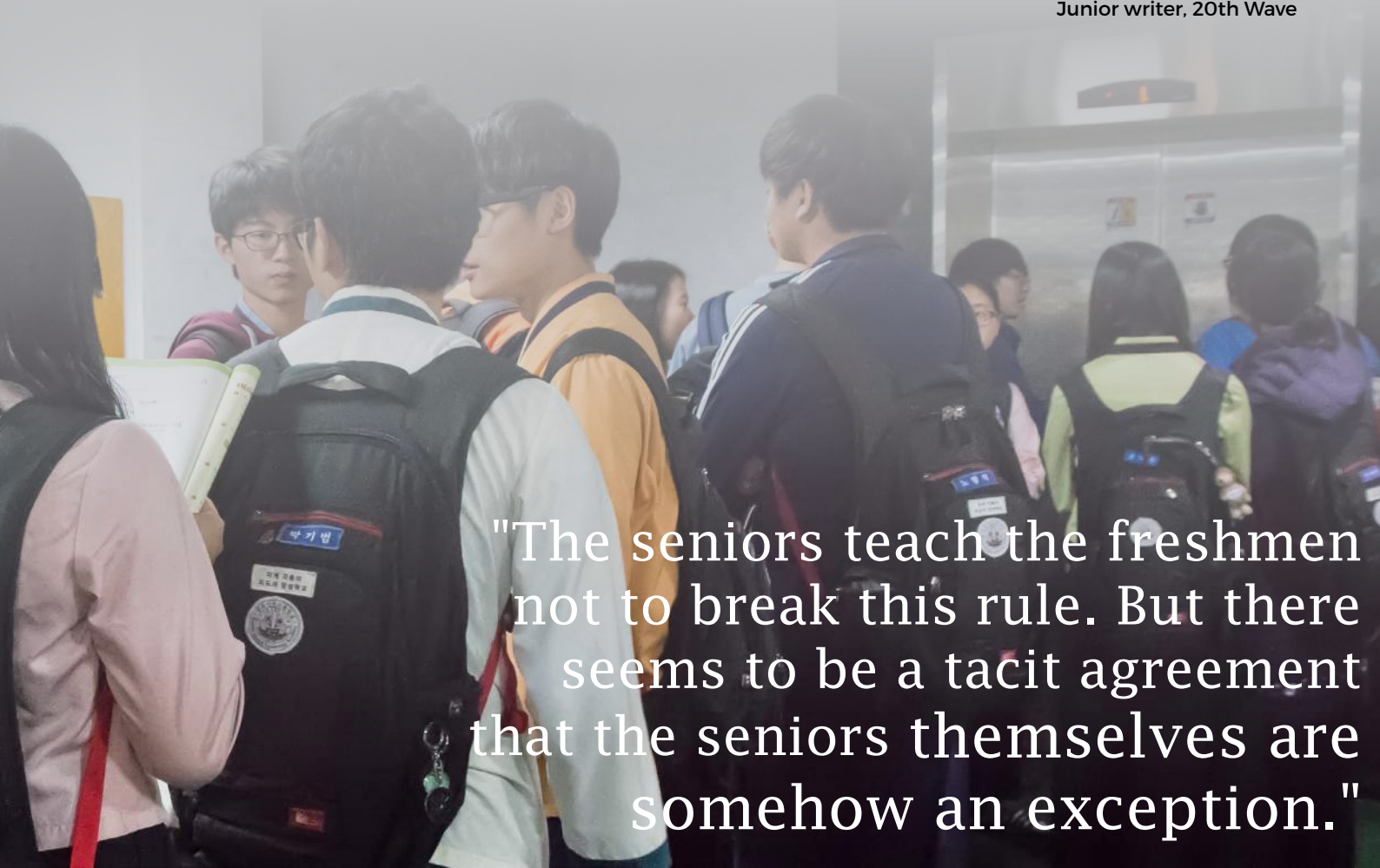
The elevator has been one of the most controversial issues among KMLAians for a long time. When students return to their rooms from morning exercise, school, or *honjeong*, they have to wait for the elevator for quite a while. Sometimes, the lines are so long that you have to wait two or three turns to take the elevator. Although there are four elevators in the dormitory, the supply still cannot satisfy the demand. Every day, KMLAians deal with their extreme minute-unit schedules that makes every minute precious, which increases the gravity of this situation.

Due to insufficient elevator supply, students started to set several rules on its use. The first is to limit elevator use for students who live on lower floors. But this could lead to a "what is the standard for low and high" controversy. Some students consider the 5th floor not high enough to take an elevator. However, others think that the 3rd floor is high enough to take an elevator. The "high" or "low" criteria is too subjective and ambiguous. Another rule is to avoid taking the elevator at the 2nd floor and basement after *honjeong*. Since almost everyone waits for the elevator after *honjeong*, it seems fair to have all students wait in the lobby. But some of the students have been criticized for disobeying this rule. Lastly, and most importantly, in case of the two central elevators, one is designated as the elevator for odd numbered floors, and the other for even numbered floors. Unfortunately, some students do not take heed of this rule.

The seniors teach the freshmen not to break this rule. But there seems to be a tacit agreement that the seniors themselves are somehow an exception. This problem led to an inter-wave conflict, mainly on KMLA Forum. One anonymous user posted that students should avoid taking elevators for short distances. The writer considered that the distance between the 4th and 5th floors is not enough for elevator use. Others disagreed. According to one user, if the restrictions for elevator usage get stricter, the existence of the elevator will become meaningless. Also, it is unfair to concentrate these inconveniences to the students who live on the lower floors of the dormitory.

For several years, the elevator shortage has led to many debates. Students criticize each other, sometimes harshly, occasionally ending up in a big conflict due to the anonymity of the forum. It is time to look for a peaceful way to resolve these futile arguments between fellow KMLAians.

Cho Sung-Min,
Junior writer, 20th Wave



"The seniors teach the freshmen not to break this rule. But there seems to be a tacit agreement that the seniors themselves are somehow an exception."

Yet Another Take on a Terminal Problem:

Department Restructuring

Shortly after the election of the 20th student council, student departments held a meeting to discuss their plans for the second semester of 2015. Despite the great policies proposed by the executive council, this meeting seemed to be not much different from the ones in previous semesters. Many departments used the allotted time for self-study and the staff members seemed uninterested in what the head and deputy head were discussing. The biggest problem, however, was that most of the given work was done by the department heads, instead of being equally distributed across the student body. This led to the problem of free ride at a massive scale. The president of the executive council has given us two solutions to solve this problem.

The most important pledge made by the president of the executive council, 19th waver Koo Min-Seok, was the "department incentive policy." It aims to address the free-rider issue by recording department activities on students' transcripts. The issue was hotly debated during the 21th student council Q&A sessions. The biggest problems were 1) objectivity, 2) activation of only particular departments.

The chief of the executive council stated that only the contents discussed during the meeting between the executive council and department heads will be written in the school records, ensuring objectivity. The executive council also answered to the second problem by saying that he will give more work to unpopular departments so that they would be incentivized to at least work for a better transcript. Though not every department can become popular, some development is better than none.

In addition, he is organizing a reward point system for five departments that have done the best work. The president of the executive council also has plans to allow reapplication to other departments after failing to enter one's first preference during the selection process.

These policies have the potential to revolutionize the way departments are perceived — if all goes as planned. However, looking back at the attempts and failures of previous executive councils, the potential of certain obstacles cannot simply be ignored.

First, there are voices that show concern about certain "non-academic" departments. While some "academic" departments might prosper, there is a chance of others such as the Department of Food & Nutrition becoming even more avoided by freshmen hopefuls. Roh Do-Hyeon, a member of the Department of Food & Nutrition, expressed his worries. "I believe that this policy might harm departments which have jobs that are irrelevant to college applications. Transporting boxes of chicken wouldn't look that prestigious to the admissions officer."

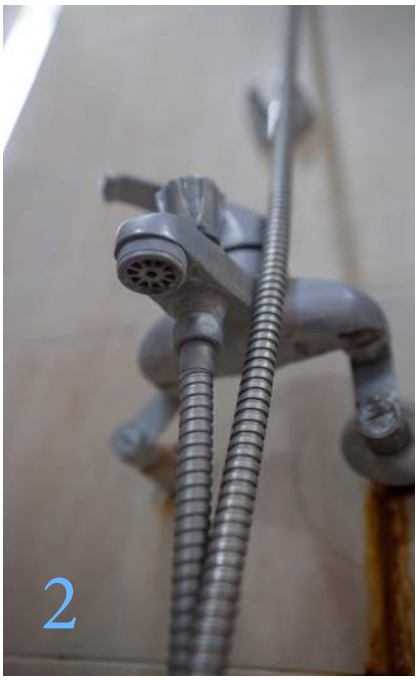
Second, the department selection system might turn out to be much more ineffective than expected. We would not have to worry too much about seeing short term effects; however, most students do not participate actively in department activities because of their tight schedule. Student perception and priorities would have to be changed along with the superficial system to bring out active participation.

Despite the doubts, the policies have the potential of showing progress in the big picture. Trial and error is a natural part of the organic drive for change. Perhaps more important than the actual policies is the attitude of the KMLA family, which should try helping the executive council in its search for incentivizing more student participation. After all, a student council without the interest of its students is an empty shell without any power.

Oh Ji-Oh
Junior writer, 20th Wave









Where Our Money Could Be Better Spent:

What Students Actually Need

Financial management. They are words rarely brought up in our everyday conversations, yet they also influence our lives in the closest manner possible. Out of limited resources, existing facilities are repaired or new ones are created. Most of the management is thoroughly done, but recent problems reveal that there is more than meets the eye.

An apt example is the installment of the face identifier. Its purpose is to control visitor access and strengthen dormitory security. However, the dormitory door is open during the weekends, making the face identifier virtually useless. In addition, the system seems incapable of opening the door through identification. On September 8th, a group of students who just finished their 10th period came back to the dormitory. The dorm parent was not in his office, so the students tried to open the door using the face identifier. However, the face identifier did not open the dormitory door for them. They ended up waiting until the dorm parent came.

Minjok Herald interviewed the dorm parent about this issue. He replied that he also admits there are problems, and listed technical issues and the inability to distinguish parents from strangers. Especially regarding technical issues, he said, "The technical issue was found immediately, almost as soon as it was first implemented." He said that the door simply didn't open and close, which caused the administration to postpone the identifier's use. "Once this error is fixed, it will be used," he said. But he mentioned that the exact plans have not been delineated yet. He also said that students accompanying their parents will solve the other problem, and the face identifier will soon be very useful.

Even after listening to the dorm parent's explanations, many students still think that the installment of the face identifier was ultimately useless. To understand what the students actually need, Minjok Herald surveyed about 50 KMLAians about their thoughts on school facilities. The following examples were the most supported opinions.

The first complaint was about the dormitory bathroom facilities. According to the survey, many of the shower rooms do not have curtains,[1] raising issues of privacy and dignity. Also, the rusted water taps show the traces of time.[2] The second complaint was about the dormitory bedrooms. It was pointed out that some rooms have holes in their ceilings,[3] while the wallpapers are torn or peeling off near the light switches.[4] Lastly, but perhaps most alarmingly, the safety of the school gym was criticized. Apparently, the gym floor is quite hazardous for bare-footed users, with sharp nails protruding from the surface.[5] 20th waver Kim Jae-Heon and many others, especially the members of the kendo club, have injured their feet while exercising at the gym.

The students' complaints about school facilities relate to important issues including safety and sanitary problems, and require proper respect. Therefore, the school needs a practical understanding of students' needs. Financial management is a complicated process and is not an issue to be taken lightly. Perhaps because the students know how the school usually uses its budget very efficiently, they seem that much more disappointed by the recent installment of the face identifier. Both the students and the school have their own positions; the school should be able to explain theirs, and the students who are educated in this school have to right to incorporate their opinions for a safer school. Communication, as usual, is key.

Park Shin-Young
Junior writer, 20th Wave

SAT vs ACT... and the New SAT?



March 2016 will be a great turning point for the SAT. The scoring system will be adjusted, the Critical Reading and Writing skills sections will be merged into a single section, and the vocabulary difficulty will be significantly lowered. Many theorize that the College Board's decision was a response to the ACT's growing popularity. Only last year, 200,000 more students took the ACT over the SAT. This trend was also true in KMLA; the percentage of the ACT takers increased from 8% in the 15th wave to 43% in the 18th wave.

> "A rating of "5" on a scale of one to five– That is, too burdensome to even consider trying."

Contrary to the College Board's ambitions, the growing concern about the new SAT seems to have only intensified the shift toward the ACT. A survey conducted on the 19th wave international field students illustrated their negative opinions on the new SAT. Fifteen out of 33 students gave the new SAT a rating of "5" on a scale of one to five – that is, too burdensome to even consider trying. Almost half of the SAT takers revealed their plans to switch to the ACT if they fail to receive satisfactory scores before next March. Others felt that the lack of information would make the new SAT difficult to prepare for, while some feared that the new scoring guidelines would put them at a disadvantage.

Anxiety for the new SAT also had a tremendous impact on the 20th wavers. On the same survey, 45.5% of the 20th wave international field students expressed their willingness to take both tests in case of poor scores on the new SAT. All of them were planning to take the ACT rather than the new SAT if they fail to receive satisfactory scores before March, eliminating the option of taking the new SAT altogether.

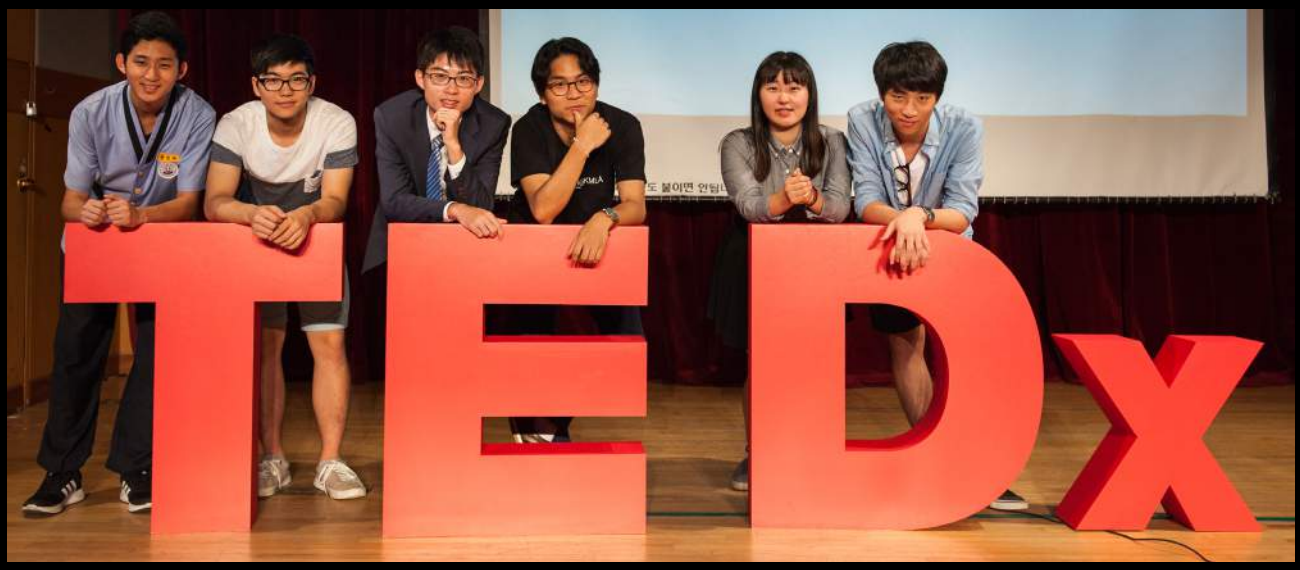
> "Bold attempts with the new test will be the only way to effectively combat the change."

While the College Admissions Office and the school library plan on providing resources to prepare students for the change, the 19th and 20th wavers are responding with outright avoidance. However, this groundless fear of experimentation will not only limit the possibilities that the new SAT could provide, but also leave future KMLA students with no precedents to base their judgments on. Bold attempts with the new test will be the only way to effectively combat change.

The Junior College Counselor Mr. Jung Ki-Won commented, "The changes may be advantageous to students experienced in logical argumentation, and disadvantageous for students specialized in math and science. However, the exact effect can only be determined through experimentation with the new system. Students should start by trying out the practice new SAT tests offered by khanacademy in https://www.khanacademy.org/."

Yoon Ji-Hoe and Lee Young-Seo
Staff writer, Junior writer
19th Wave, 20th Wave

KMLA's First TED^{x}, and Hopefully Not Its Last



On August 19th, 2015, KMLA hosted its very first TEDx conference on the theme "pioneer". Six students gave speeches along with two guest speakers, Sakiroo Choi and Mark Barthelemy. The event was held from 1PM to 5PM in the Dasan Hall auditorium, organized by the EOP department and supported by Mr. Scott Garrioch.

TED (short for Technology, Entertainment, Design) is well-known for its relatively short yet powerful talks. TEDx is similar to TED, having the same format, but planned and carried out independently in small local communities.

The first KMLA TEDx seems to have been fairly successful. We had a variety of topics dealt by invited guest speakers. 18th waver Han Ji-Won, Han Jun-Yeob, Kim Woon-Ha, Chang Min-Woo, Lee Su-Yeon, and 19th waver Yoon Jung-Chan made speeches about different topics including politics, physics, and philosophy. We also had a special intermission led by the fusion rock band Sosaoreum.

> "The trouble with this TEDx was (...) the unfortunate circumstances that left the auditorium half-empty."

This result was possible due to the deliberate planning and preparing of many people. Kim Kang-San, who had a big portion of the responsibility for this event quoted, "Getting the license for the TEDx took two years, a lot of preparing, a failure, and even more preparing. It was a lot of work."

However, there were problems; the explicit problem was that there weren't enough people in the audience. The conference coincided with the camps of both KMLA and Minjok Orchestras, which prevented a large number of students from attending. Even those who remained preferred to stay in their rooms. This led to the dorm parent broadcasting that students free for the afternoon should consider dropping by. Despite the efforts, the auditorium was quite empty, and a big portion of the audience was a group of elementary/middle school students that came to listen to the conference.

The general consensus was that the trouble with this TEDx was not with the speakers or their speeches, but rather the unfortunate circumstances that left the auditorium half-empty. Students who went there and listened to the speeches until the end of the occasion were mostly satisfied with the quality of the speeches.

Another problem was in the process of planning the event. Those who were in the planning team of the event spoke out that the school did not give enough support. 19th waver Roh Shin-Young said, "We had a hard time because of the lack of support. We had difficulties due to financial insufficiency, and we had to look for invited guest speakers all by ourselves, without the school's help. It was as if we were mere smallshots trying to get people to participate in our insignificant event. The school didn't even advertise the event properly to the students, which made some students think that the event was a triviality. I was embarrassed to show the invited speakers the numerous open seats."

We must ask ourselves, how could we boost participation for the next TEDxKMLA? The administrators should come up with new, intriguing programs. Some propose the system of mandatory participation, but most people say that would muddle the whole point of this unique program. Also, if we were to hold another conference, there should be sufficient support on the planning process from the school so that the planning team could manage to plan a proper program without overworking themselves. Still, the first TEDx@KMLA was a good start and showed us the potential of improvement. We hope to see this event prosper in consecutive years, with the enthusiastic cheer of the student body and the school in the background.

Lee Young-Seo and Choi Hee
Junior writers, 20th Wave

TEACHERS OF KMLA



Teachers are more than just academic instructors; they lead individual lives as vivid as our own. This edition, "Teachers of KMLA" aims to highlight how little we know about our fellow cohabitants' lives. Therefore, we dedicate the following four pages to the teachers who live closest to us — in the dorms — as an homage to the entire KMLA family.





Hola, Profesora Lete!

Perhaps one of the most influential figures at KMLA, Dr. Kim Kyung-Ju, or widely known as Lete the Spanish teacher, is well-known for her close interactions with her students. She lives on the first floor of the Deokgo House and seems to know a great deal about its inhabitants. Yet, she also remains a mysterious figure to most students. So Minjok Herald gathered some answers, which students craved so dearly, to satisfy their curiosity.

1. You always keep your hair red and your hanbok flashy. Do you have any specific reason? Or is it just part of your style?

I guess it is just my style. I started dying my hair for practical reasons. When I came back to Korea from Spain, I was 34 years old. Surprisingly, my hair was patched with some white hair. Though I wished to keep my hair the way it was as honorable evidence of my academic efforts, my mother suggested that I dye my hair.I started dying my hair when I was 35 or 36, so I have been doing it for about one or two years (my age is a secret^^). As for my hanbok, it is what I wear throughout the day, so I like to keep it flashy. It would be good for both me and people I meet if my hanbok is pleasing to the eyes.

2. Who is your ideal type of man?

It feels a little weird to be answering this kind of question to my students. Still, I feel grateful towards my students for having such interest in me! My kind of man is...Park Ji-sung? Son Heung-Min? Or perhaps G-Dragon? I used to publicly list three conditions that made a man attractive in my eyes. But whenever I said it, students would smirk and say, "That's why you are unmarried, Professor Lete!" So I will not confess them. Now, I just want a man who finds I am attractive."

3. Was there a student who was so impressive that you still remember him/her?

I find this question very difficult to answer because it is my motto as an educator that I try my hardest to teach all my students, and forget them completely after they graduate. Well... if I have to pick a certain student, one in the 11th wave comes to mind. The student had transferred to the international field at the start of senior year, and had to take many exams like the SAT and AP in a short period of time. But the student was also adamant in his decision to take the Spanish SAT and DELE, which were relatively unnecessary. After he received applaudable scores on both, I asked why he took such a risk. He then replied that he wished to test the limits of his abilities. I was, of course, extremely impressed. Since then, I have believed in the potential of KMLA students.

Han Ji-Min
Junior feature writer, 20th Wave

Meet Our Dorm Parent



Mr. Kim Byung-Moo, our daytime dormitory officer, is known for his friendliness toward KMLA students. Minjok Herald utilized this opportunity to share some special episodes that reveal Mr. Kim's avuncular character.

The first episode came from 18th waver Ryu Hyun-Seung:

"I went down to the dormitory office to confess that I had done *shinseong* for my friend while he was still asleep. I anxiously waited for Mr. Kim to give me penalty points and send me away to my room. Instead, he commended my bravery-acting like a 'real man' to quote his exact words. He said that he appreciated my honesty and thanked me for confessing the truth. I still vividly remember his genial smile and warmth."

Another interesting episode came from 19th waver Kang Woo-Sang:

"On the first day of school, I had many bags with me. As I was passing by the gate, Mr. Kim asked if I could take a look at his computer because it was malfunctioning. After fixing the computer, I came out to tell Mr. Kim. Surprisingly, some of my bags were gone! Confused, I asked Mr. Kim, who was getting off the elevator, if he had seen my bags. He said that he had moved them to my room. I was very thankful because some of them were too heavy for me to carry alone. Thanks to Mr. Kim's help, I could move all my bags to my room."

The cutest episode was told by 18th waver Park Jung-Hoon:

"One Sunday afternoon, Mr. Kim urgently called me to come down to his office. Although I had done nothing wrong, I could not stop feeling nervous and guilty. Sweating a little bit, I entered his office. Mr.Kim asked me in a very serious tone, 'Do you know how to use this gift voucher as real money?' His question stupefied me for a moment. I still laugh whenever I recall that event."

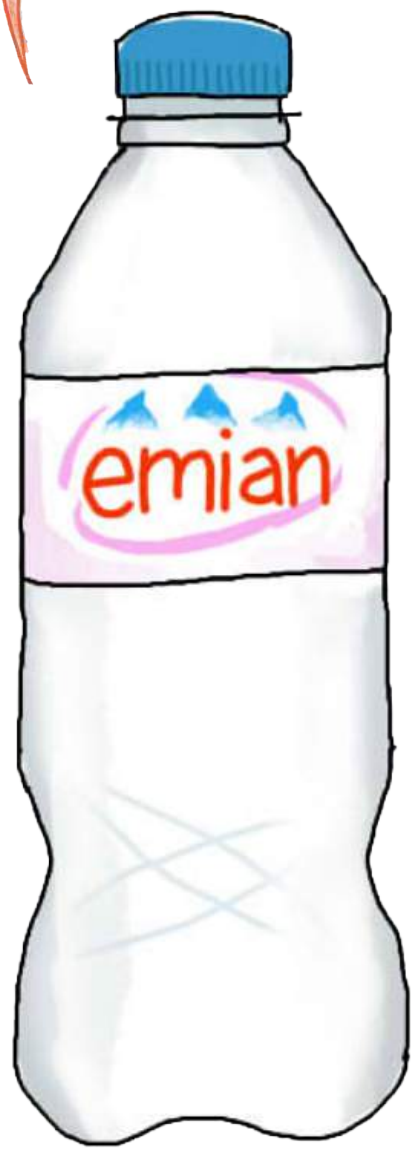
Through these episodes, we can get a sense of how much Mr. Kim means to us. It is not only about keeping us physically safe or checking *shinseong* on weekends. Rather, it is about his personality and presence itself. Sometimes, even a disciplined, independent, and hard-working KMLA student needs someone to depend upon. Thankfully, Mr. Kim is always there in his office to comfort us with real-life advice, humor, and a smile.

Lee Yong-Hun
Junior feature writer, 20th Wave





THE PUNNIEST TEACHER IN SCHOOL



Back in 2009, TVXQ's song "Mirotic" took Korea by storm with its chic beats. The song was played in every shopping mall and every bus station, and the addictive rhythm was stuck in the heads of many. A few years later, a brand new addition to the KMLA science department, who called himself Dr. Mirotic, made a rather noticeable appearance in Dasan Hall... and the rest is history. The arrival of Dr. Lee Joo-Moon revolutionized the sense of humour among the faculty members.

Dr. Lee has been a huge fan of "bad" jokes from the very first day he arrived at KMLA. Most students who have taken his chemistry classes pick his fondness for puns as his most distinct trait. In fact, Dr. Lee's nickname, Dr. Mirotic, is a pun in itself. The Korean title for TVXQ's "Mirotic" is Joo-Moon, so you get the idea. Thanks to his wide use of creative and original jokes, Dr. Lee never fails to give students a chance to laugh their stress off.

Most students respond to Dr. Lee's humor with positive remarks. 20th wavers, So-Hee and Hwa-Jung, both of whom were enthusiastic freshmen in Dr. Lee's SAT Chemistry class, said that his jokes are both educational and entertaining, helping them understand chemistry concepts and stay awake and focused in class. Jae-Heon, another 20th wave student who will be taking Dr. Lee's class, extolled his ubiquitous smile and sense of humour. He added that Dr. Lee's beaming smile cheers up others around him. Meanwhile, not many students saw his jokes as an affectation or a hindrance to classwork.

Dr. Mirotic is undoubtedly a passionate, open-minded, and extremely intelligent educator. He currently lives on the second floor of the dormitory, so he is a next door neighbor for some of his students, always up for a friendly conversation or two. To Dr. Lee, or Dr. Mirotic, I should say, jokes are not just part of his habit, but his desire to reach out to his students and help us feel exuberant about chemistry, school, and beyond. So the next time you hear him making a joke, try to make it the tonic that helps you get through an extraordinarily tiring day. Apparently for his chemistry students, enthusiasm works.

Jung Chan-Young
Junior feature writer, 20th Wave

I Go to Sleep at 4 A.M.



There is a familiar creature inhabiting the 8th floor of the Deokgo House. She often takes her victims by surprise; her habits include silently slipping into dorm rooms and catching students for computer violation, cleaning violation, self-study violation and many more. The residents of the 6th, 7th, and 8th floors hurry to organize their seats before she reaches them from their behind. Very few students know of her thoroughly hidden identity, though, and rumors about her past spring up every now and then.

Our featured mysterious character is Park Ju-Young, the girls' dorm parent. After nine years in the military, she came to KMLA and is now awaiting her eleventh year. Minjok Herald had an interview with Ms. Park to explore her affectionate character concealed by her intimidating facial expression and all-time radiant chill. Here are some responses that reveal — only partially — her love towards KMLA students.

MH: Are there any former students who left a lasting impression?

Ms. Park: I was never especially attentive to a particular student. Everyone was similar, yet different in his or her own way. One thing all students had in common was their geniality. I was grateful to watch the kids' naughtiness subside in their senior years. Students seem to rub out each other's corners as they quarrel and resolve conflicts. I am always surprised by how even the most mischievous ones return as mature adults after they graduate.

MH: Do you have any advice for our students?

Ms. Park: I must emphasize the importance of self-management. Diligence improves one's abilities and reaps satisfying results. I'd also like to add that you should take care of each other. A few of you are still immature and tease your friends without contemplating the consequences of your actions. Lastly, I hope that all of you grow up as independent individuals with courage to admit your mistakes and ask for forgiveness. You see, I can tell whether or not you are lying to me. (Smile) I'm never personally offended or bear grudges on students, so I urge you to be honest with me - just like with everyone else.

Some students may disbelieve the image of Ms. Park brimming with affection and warmth. Meanwhile, Ms. Park will probably maintain her not-so-obvious affection by scolding and giving penalty points to students. However, let us never forget the famous anecdote in which she got a call from a sick student at night and accompanied her to the hospital at three in the morning. "I go to sleep at 4 A.M. every day." Her words left a long-lasting impression.

Cho Hae-Min
Junior feature writer, 20th Wave

"Goal of English Only Policy: English is only a tool to raise Korea to the highest level by accommodating diverse civilizations and cultures in accordance with Korean tradition. English Only Policy is merely a means, not an end in itself."

Every Monday, KMLA students recite the Goal of English Only Policy. When asked about the purpose of EOP, Ms. Hwang So-Hee answered, "The point of EOP is to make English familiar and to enhance the ability to speak English." This clearly is the primary goal of EOP. However, it does not stop there. The fundamental goal of EOP lies in helping KMLA students use sophisticated English to communicate about culture, information, and knowledge in the international society. It asks students to discuss math in English, humanities in English, and science in English.

THE PRIMARY GOAL

The primary goal is one that the school tries to promote. English conversation is mandated through the use of plus/penalty points as a carrot and a stick. Daily English conversation would eventually bring familiarity with English and enhancement in English abilities. However, many students don't live up to that goal. There were 11 cases of EOP violation in the 22nd court. The tendency to not speak English in daily conversation seems predominant among students. Regarding the primary goal, some voice out that the school should come up with better policies.

THE EOP PROMOTER POLICY

The EOP Promoter policy is one such program to encourage English speaking. Certain students are assigned the position of "EOP Promoter", whose job is to start conversations in English. If one successfully carries out the job for a week, he or she earns an award point.

Choah Lee, the vice president of the 19th Legislative Council, first introduced this policy on August 21st during the EOP policy conference, where the idea was favorably received. However, issues started to arise on August 23rd during the Assembly of Representatives. The representatives questioned the legitimacy of the EOP Promoter policy, as all students are already required to use English during their school hours. Many were wary of the policy's actual effectiveness. At the end of the day, the policy failed to earn the assembly's approval, with only 27% agreeing. According to the Articles of Student Autonomy, a majority of the representatives has to agree on a policy for it to pass on to the class council. This policy, therefore, should not have passed.

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So naturally, when the policy was shown to the whole school for class voting the next day, people started asking questions. Choah Lee, justifying this aberration, said, "The Assembly of Representatives' decision was unreliable, due to a few representatives leading the atmosphere of the whole assembly." The result of the class vote seemed to prove her point; 83.15% agreed with the policy. Upon closer inspection, though, the vote only brought further controversy. The Articles of Student Autonomy state that voters must be given three choices: agree, disagree, or agree with the intention, but disagree with the policy itself. This time, the last option was not provided. With just 19 less votes in favor, the policy would have been passed back to the Assembly of Representatives, providing more time to discuss its content. In such a situation when every vote counts, the seemingly high support rate may have been inflated due to the absence of one alternative option to choose from.

"It is *EVERYONE'S* fault"

Regardless of this dispute, the policy was passed. Though the actual effectiveness of the EOP Promoter policy remains a matter of debate, it succeeded in shining the spotlight on EOP. The existence of this article makes that much obvious. Better policies may be necessary for promotion of English conversation, but it is not a prerequisite. The prerequisite is that the students want to and try to speak English. One representative argued in the Assembly of Representatives, "We can try this policy. However, the ultimate change has to happen within ourselves." At the end of the day, we are the ones who must change.

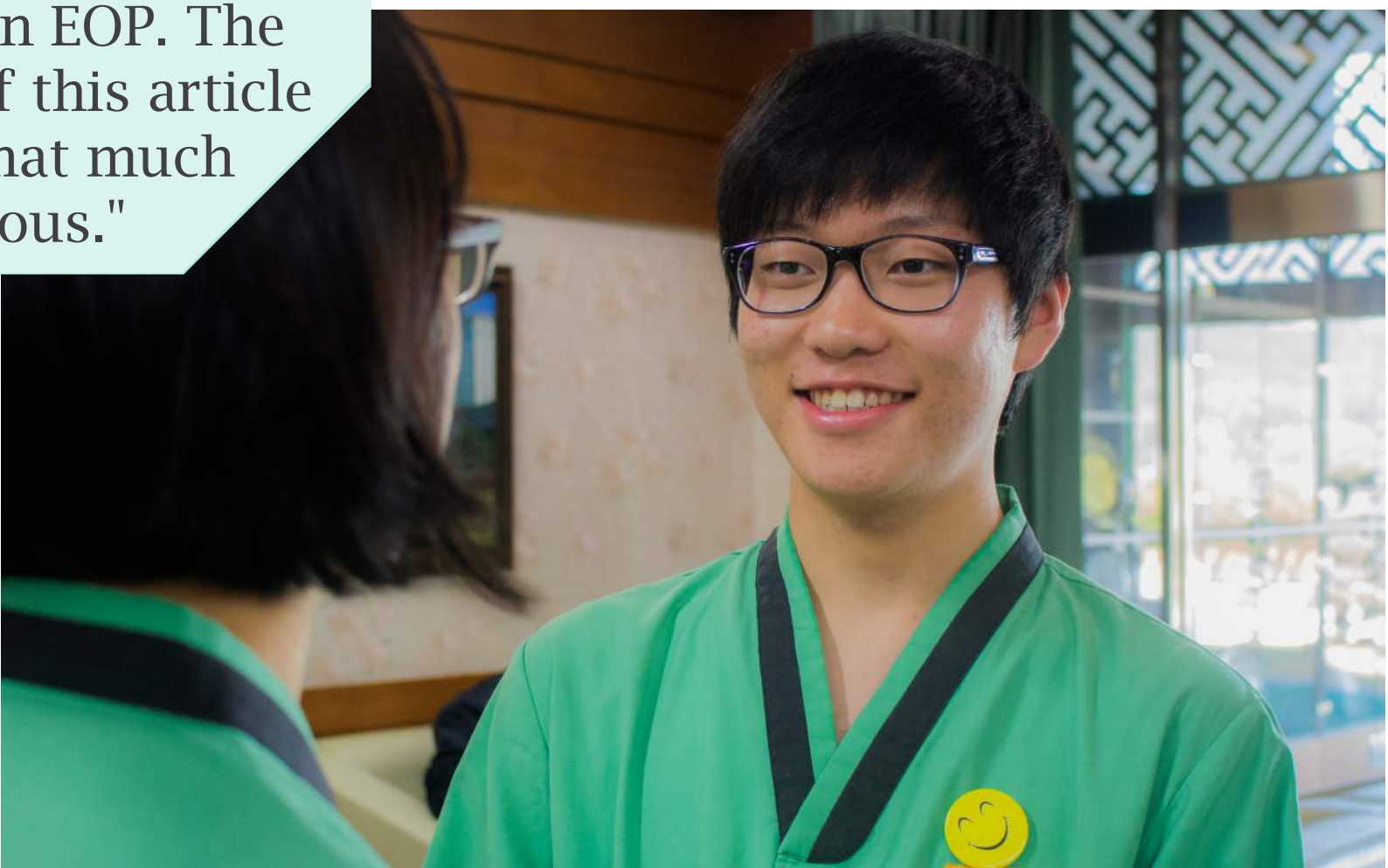
THE FUNDAMENTAL GOAL

In the process of focusing on the primary goal, though, it seems that the focal point behind the 'Goal of English Only Policy' has been lost. The students are not provided with the environment in which they can partake in English conversation at a more professional, academic level. Students may all have fun joking around in English, but not enough effort is spent into fostering high quality English discourse on, say, trigonometric functions. In order to achieve this goal, advanced classes have to be taught in English and teachers should lead discussions in English. This would enable students to use English terms in academic conversation. The teachers would be an excellent example for the students. Sadly, this is not something that happens in KMLA.

It is everyone's fault. The students don't try to live up to the goals and the school has forgotten the fundamentals of the goal. Students need to change their attitude and the school must provide the high quality English-friendly environment that was promised in the first place. EOP can only be revived through cooperative effort.

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“Liberty is only granted to those who live up to the responsibilities that follow.”

The 20th student council election was held on September 4th, 2015. The detailed plans of the election, however, were revealed on August 21st, granting students only two weeks before the election to show advocacy. Some might say that in the end, the student body was provided with a free and fair election. They might also argue that the problems of this semester's election are not particularly special, as difficulties are already an accepted part of KMLA's election system and will always be. However, as members of the 20th Board of Elections, we as insiders of the event came to the inevitable conclusion that the 20th student council election had all these existing problems – only maximized. There are mainly three points of contention: candidate assignment, question-and-answer sessions, and candidate tendencies.

THE 20TH STUDENT COUNCIL ELECTION: AN INSIDER'S VIEW

To begin with, the candidate assignments of each committee (legislative, executive, and judicial) were disclosed to the students on August 23rd, 2015. The candidates had six days to organize their thoughts and answer the questions. There were only two days for the students and the press to read through the assignments. Therefore, the students failed to give proper attention to the candidate assignments, which is a primary method of understanding the candidates' plans or values. Compared to last semester, the number of views of the judicial council's candidate assignments reduced by 43%, and the number of comments reduced from 15 to zero. The legislative and executive councils' situations were not so different. Clearly, there was a definite decrease in the interest of the students towards the election. KMLA Online did not live up to its function of being utilized by the students to actively debate with the candidates.

Next, the question-and-answer sessions had many issues as well.

First, we can address the quality of the Q&A sessions. The sessions were carried out with the goal of identifying the thoughts that each candidate had concerning not only specific issues, but also school government in general. However, some of the questions failed in fulfilling this goal. In a survey conducted after the first Q&A session held on August 31st, students questioned the content of each council's Q&A session. The executive council, for instance, was criticized for asking general questions that were similar to the candidate assignments, thereby failing to give much insight to the voters. Also, many questions in the sessions were not designed for specific candidates, but for the candidates who volunteered to answer first. This led to the spotlight being focused on the one or two candidates who were simply fast enough in raising their hands.

The second problem was that the third grade seniors did not mandatorily attend the question-and-answer sessions. Only six seniors attended the session, but considering the fact that the majority of 18th wavers voted, we must question the grounds on which they cast their votes. If the online articles prepared by the student press had given them indirect opportunities to look into candidates, there would be less concern, but as the number of views for the articles written by the press was also low, that seems highly unlikely. Another problem was the attitude of the students listening to the question-and-answer sessions. This might have been the problem of the student council and the department of student guidance, for they were unable to create an attentive audience. However, there is no doubt that students should've shown more respect towards the candidates and the board of election. The first step towards creating a healthy school government is to select its constituents with respect and care. Liberty is only granted to those who live up to the responsibilities that follow.

Furthermore, a specific trend seemed to appear among the candidates for the 20th student council election. One is that the overall number of applicants has reduced recently. Only one person out of the total candidates has failed to win a spot. As all the 19th wave candidates knew that they were going to be automatically elected, it is hard to refrain from questioning whether they had done their best during the election period. Another tendency was that no student from domestic natural science field ran for candidacy among 19th wavers. As the main function of the student council is to represent the whole student body, it is a concern if the student council cannot effectively represent the domestic natural science field students that make up most of the student body.

> "No student from Domestic Natural Science field ran for Candidacy among 19th wavers"

Despite these problems, some positive signs could also be found. With a total of 336 votes, the voter turnout was higher than that of last year's. Furthermore, issue-oriented posters by the school press, posted on the walls of Dasan and Chungmoo Halls, have definitely played a crucial role in preventing a "popularity vote," allowing students to gain basic understanding on the stance of each candidate. Although there were many problems with the 20th student council election, it also showed signs of progress. It is crucial that future student councils reevaluate past elections and attempt to fix the seemingly unsolvable problems, developing the election culture and student autonomy in KMLA to a higher level.

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Recent conflicts between the students and teachers of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy have brought two changes to the school regulations. The first change forces students to wear *yebok* until fourth period on Monday, and the second change prohibits students from using plastic nametags to replace the nametag attached to the *hanbok*. These sudden changes reveal flaws in the communication between students and teachers.

WE NEED TO TALK...



The unilateral form of communication from the teachers to the students has resulted in both sides feeling offended. The introduction of the regulation regarding *yebok* clearly illustrates this. Through surveys, it has already been established that most students are indifferent about wearing *yebok* until lunch. So why all the drama? The biggest complaint students had was the method in which the regulation was introduced. It was announced that changes would be made to the official school regulation if the students disobeyed the new rules. As KMLA prides its student government, such a hasty introduction to a regulations naturally seemed inappropriate.

A similar case is the sudden ban of plastic nametags. The ban was unexpected and therefore, students did not have adequate time to discuss alternatives. Furthermore, the logic behind the ban were vaguely described; thus, students were not able to fix the problem before the regulation was enforced. If students had been given the time and opportunity to improve their behavior, the need for a ban would have been minimal. However, students were forced to passively accept the change without such an opportunity. In order to truly improve our world as leaders of various groups, students must actively promote justice, and the lack of communication limits students from improving their behavior and reaching an acceptable compromise that benefits both groups.

However, it is important to note that teachers are not the only ones to blame regarding the problem of communication. The fault also lies within the students and the student council for having failed to effectively utilize the various opportunities that had already been provided by the school. The outrage caused by the proposal of a ban on earphones highlights the students' failure to communicate in an objective manner. Of course, students' instinctive anger against the complete ban of earphones was somewhat inevitable. However, some students were simply carried away by their emotions and overreacted in an irrational manner. Even worse, their radical words spread through the school via internet and aroused similar emotions in even those students who did not originally feel this way. Such thoughts, once publicized, can compromise the integrity of the entire communication process.

Another scenario reveals the students' inability to utilize the opportunities given by the teachers. Manager of the Dormitory Office, Mr. Kim Dae-Gi, instructed all students to open the "metal doors" of the dormitory rooms. Feeling that such a regulation was unnecessary and unjust, members of the legislative branch were able to persuade Mr. Kim to give a two week grace period. If the amount of computer violations decreased during this period, the command to open the doors would be lifted. Students were all aware of this grace period; however, the amount of computer violations failed to decrease. If students truly believed that the directions given by Mr. Kim were unjust, they should have tried their best during the grace period. Not only did the students lose Mr. Kim's trust, but they also showed their lack of interest in pursuing justice.

The relationship between teachers and students is definitely not meant to be a competition for political authority, but rather a cooperative effort with the common objective to "make a better school." Students should strive to make full use of the opportunities granted by the teachers and appreciate their attempts to communicate with the students. Teachers, on the other hand, should acknowledge the students' efforts to cooperate with them. Only with guaranteed mutual respect can the school properly fulfill open communication.

"SONDER"

(n.) The realization that each random passerby is living a life as vivid and complex as your own - populated with their own ambitions, friends, routines, worries and inherited craziness - an epic story that continues invisibly around you like an anthill sprawling deep underground, with elaborate passageways to thousands of other lives that you'll never know existed, in which you might appear only once, as an extra sipping coffee in the background, as a blur of traffic passing on the highway, as a lighted window at dusk.

- The Dictionary of Obscure Sorrows